

Chapter 88_2 - Secret (Part 2 Continued)

Suddenly, a white light appeared behind Ning Changfeng. She nimbly raised her hand to summon her long sword, dispelling the white light with one move, then spun around to block in front of the bed, coldly looking at the newcomer.

"Divine Venerable, are you here to see Fuyi?" She curved her lips in a smile, but her body didn't move aside.

"Stop pretending. You know what I'm here to do. Step aside." Chu Qingqiu held her white jade staff with killing intent, pointing it directly at the infant on the bed.

Her eyes were indifferent, as if looking at a dead object.

"What if I say I won't let you?" Ning Changfeng still didn't move, but smiled lightly.

"That day, I ate the fruit of the Sacred Wood Manduo¹, which caused her to take form and be reborn in my womb. This was originally my mistake. Moreover, neither medicine nor cultivation could make me lose her, which shows how much she wanted to be born. Since she is the child I carried for ten months and gave birth to, she is Ning Changfeng's child. I will never let anyone touch her."

"Ning Changfeng, don't be obstinate." Chu Qingqiu spoke. "You know she bears a curse. In the future, she will definitely be despised by both humans and ghosts. Only those who are pure and kind will treat her well, but those who love her will all die because of her. In the future, even you will die by her hands!"

"Moreover, she has demonic roots. Keeping her alive is leaving a calamity for the Six Realms."

"You want her to live ordinary while bearing the fate of being despised by humans and ghosts. It's better to kill her now to spare her from suffering betrayal and isolation later, and from cultivating the demonic path!" After Chu Qingqiu finished speaking, her long sleeves danced lightly, and white silk quickly extended toward the infant, but was cut off by Ning Changfeng's sword.

"She knows nothing. To lose her life just because of a curse—what kind of reasoning is this! Even if she becomes a demon in the future, she isn't one now. She is just Ning Fuyi now. What right do we have to decide her life or death!" Ning Changfeng was forced to redden her eyes, speaking word by word.

"When we eliminated demons and monsters, you never blinked an eye. Now don't show such favoritism toward her just because she's your child." Chu Qingqiu raised her peach blossom eyes that seemed frosted over.

"I'm not showing favoritism." Ning Changfeng stepped back two steps and grabbed the bed post. "If she commits evil today, I will personally kill her with one sword. But she doesn't understand anything yet. Even if it were someone else lying here today, I wouldn't touch her."

"Kill one person to save the world—I won't do it, and I don't want to."

Chu Qingqiu looked at her deeply, but seemed not to be moved at all. She raised her hand to push Ning Changfeng aside, and the white jade staff in her palm shot toward the infant's face like lightning.

However, at this moment, Ning Changfeng transformed into flowing light and appeared again. She didn't even raise her sword, but used her chest to receive that staff. Blood immediately gushed out, and she supported herself against the bed post, bending over in pain, her black hair scattered and soaked with blood.

Seeing this, Chu Qingqiu finally showed a trace of surprise. She pulled back her white staff and shouted sternly: "Ning Changfeng!"

Ning Changfeng's fingers spasmed from pain. She clutched the clothes at her chest tightly, looked up at Chu Qingqiu, and smiled.

"I know you disdain human emotions and were born only for the common people. I won't strike at you, nor will I watch you kill Yiyi."

She struggled to straighten her waist, tilted her head back to look down at Chu Qingqiu, exposing her pale neck: "If you insist on killing her today, then kill me first. This matter started because of me, so I should accompany her in death."

Chu Qingqiu gripped the white staff tightly, anger surging, looking as if she was about to be driven mad by Ning Changfeng.

After an unknown amount of time, she lowered her head, and the white staff turned into light smoke.

Then, without saying a word, she turned and left with heavy footsteps. Only then did Ning Changfeng lean against the bed's edge and sit on the ground, reaching out with her blood-stained hand to touch Ning Fuyi's swaddling clothes.

The infant giggled.

"Silly child, just like your mother—you can smile no matter when." She lay back with her head up, smiling weakly.

"Mother is incompetent. I can't protect you to live safely and happily. I can only guard you and want you to live well."

The light dimmed, leaving only sand and dust on the ground, along with shattered glass bottles.

Ning Fuyi stood silently in place. She raised her hand to stroke under her eyes and felt wetness all over her hand.

Nine Infants was also speechless. She pulled a handkerchief from her waist and handed it to Ning Fuyi: "There are two more bottles left. Do you want to see them all, or take a break?"

"Open them," Ning Fuyi said.

So Nine Infants also learned her method and flicked open the bottle cap. The two watched another scene appear.

This time it wasn't Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate, nor was Chu Qingqiu there. Instead, it was a pavilion nestled against green mountains. The Ning Changfeng here was exactly like the one in Ning Fuyi's memory—blue robes, long hair arranged in a bun, but her expression was very weary.

"Divine Doctor Jiang, my injury..."

"Condensing Heaven Sect Leader² still asks." Jiang Li's eyes rippled, smiling without warmth as she faced her. "If you had come a few steps later, you would have died on my Wu Mountain."

"Sorry." Ning Changfeng curved her lips.

Jiang Li helplessly withdrew her silver threads and took out pills from her medicine box: "Take this Life-Extending Pill first. But no matter how hard I try, it's only treating the symptoms, not the root cause. If you keep cutting away your cultivation from your body like this, sooner or later you'll have qi deviation. When that time comes, even a True God couldn't save you."

"Alright, I understand." Ning Changfeng nodded and threw the pill into her mouth without even looking.

"Farewell. I won't stay on the mountain for a meal today. I still have to go back and continue cutting away my cultivation." Ning Changfeng got up to bid farewell to Jiang Li, then left on her sword.

"Condensing Heaven Sect Leader!" Jiang Li immediately stood up, so annoyed that she abandoned her immortal demeanor and rolled her eyes dramatically.

Cutting away cultivation... Ning Fuyi's heart felt a sharp pain, hurting so much she almost knelt down. Fortunately, Nine Infants supported her.

The extra pink immortal power in her body was actually... actually Ning Changfeng's?

It seemed that in the previous life, the curse had suppressed Ning Changfeng's cultivation, so she had never felt the existence of immortal power. Then in this life, the immortal power appeared and more good people appeared around her because the curse was lifted?

Who lifted the curse?

She hurriedly grabbed another bottle and, without hesitation, threw it into the air. Light appeared again, and flowing sand fell.

But this time, no scene appeared. Ning Fuyi stared with reddened eyes at the falling sand grains, her nails digging into her flesh.

Nine Infants looked around for a long time but saw nothing, looking at Ning Fuyi in confusion: "Is this bottle expired?"

"This bottle isn't a scene, it's sound—the curse from the ancient evil spirit back then." Ning Fuyi said in a low voice.

"What curse? Why can't I hear it?" Nine Infants tapped her ears.

"I heard it." Ning Fuyi closed her eyes, her voice neither bitter nor smiling.

"Mine is a life without love, despised by humans and ghosts."

"Chu Qingqiu's is that her loved ones meet their end, unable to cross the emotional barrier³."

Author's Note:

These two chapters are only from mother's perspective, so they can't explain everything clearly. There's still Divine Venerable's part to come~

Yiyi, cry more! The more you cry, the faster our little sprout Divine Venerable can grow up (evil smile)

Footnotes

¹ **Sacred Wood Manduo** - A mystical fruit that can cause spiritual transformation or reincarnation when consumed

² **Condensing Heaven Sect Leader** - Ning Changfeng's title as the leader of the Condensing Heaven sect

³ **Unable to cross the emotional barrier** - Refers to being unable to overcome emotional attachments or relationships, often leading to tragedy in cultivation stories